MONTHLY UPDATE

Data protection: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-12 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *28 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.*

ANGOLA · BENIN · BOTSWANA · CAPE VERDE · EGYPT · ESWATINI · GABON · GHANA · KENYA · LESOTHO · LIBERIA · MALAWI · MALI · MAURITIUS · MOROCCO · MOZAMBIQUE · NAMIBIA · NIGERIA · SENEGAL · SEYCHELLES · SIERRA LEONE · SOUTH AFRICA · TANZANIA · TOGO · TUNISIA · UGANDA · ZAMBIA · ZIMBABWE

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Angola

The data protection agency's own register now gives the full run of its penalties: 15 sanctions between 2022 and 2026, from US$75,000 to US$525,000, with banks, telecoms operators, the national airline and the Luanda water utility among those fined.

Benin

The data-protection authority took its position abroad rather than issuing it at home. Its president told a fintech regulators' forum in Johannesburg that trust, cooperation between regulators and coordination with financial authorities are what secure the growth of artificial intelligence and cross-border data flows. It is a set of recommendations rather than an instrument, and no bilateral or regional arrangement follows from it on the record.

Botswana

The commencement instrument behind the data-protection regime is now held in full: Statutory Instrument 86 of 2021 brought the Data Protection Act No. 32 of 2018 into operation on publication on 15 October 2021. It dates a regime the repository had been carrying from its 2024 re-enactment, and it is the kind of document that settles when an obligation actually started rather than when it was last restated.

Cape Verde

Oversight of the state's own intelligence capability moved by administrative act rather than statute, and the act is contested. The prime minister's delegation of powers over the Republic's information service to the minister of internal administration was formalised by despacho no 15/2026 in the official gazette, with the opposition calling it unconstitutional, the government invoking the delegation regime provided for in the Organic Law of the Government, and the President of the Republic declining to address it publicly after discussing it with the prime minister. The despacho text is not held, so whether the delegated powers reach communications interception or data access is not established here.

Egypt

A joint decision of the media council and the telecoms regulator, reported on 17 September, bars social platforms from holding independent accounts for children under 13, makes a safe mode the child cannot disable compulsory for those aged 13 to under 15, and requires age verification that collects no more data than it needs. The regulator says platforms have three months to comply, existing accounts included, and can be blocked in Egypt if they do not, and that tens of thousands subscribed in two months to the operators' child online-protection services. The decision's text is not held.

On 29 September two rights organisations asked the media council and the telecoms regulator to publish the joint decision's full text, number and legal basis, which the 17 September announcement did not carry, and to state what age-verification data will be collected, by whom and for how long. A law firm reported that the data-protection centre opened its portal for accreditation, licence and permit applications in early October 2026, weeks before the grace period ends.

Eswatini

The data protection authority is taking information desks into major towns in an outreach campaign, reported on 17 September.

Gabon

The data protection authority described itself, which is the most the record holds about it. Its president set out the mandate and its limits: the authority holds a regulatory power to set rules published in the official journal, personal data remains the property of the citizen while collectors hold and process it, and insult and digital communication fall outside its competence and to the media regulator — which is what it is most often asked about. He put dealing directly with the large social platforms as requiring a common African response rather than a national one. No budget, staffing, caseload or enforcement action for the authority is published, so its independence is asserted rather than evidenced.

Ghana

The regulator's own first-half numbers reached the repository on 7 September, and they measure activity rather than enforcement: a 51.5% rise in regulatory activity and a 98.4% rise in newly registered data controllers over the first half of 2026, with a public campaign put at an estimated 25 million people reached. The controller figure is a growth rate published without the repository it grew from, and no fine or prosecution has yet been published. The President confirmed publicly in New York that Cabinet rejected the United States health agreement over demands for pathogen samples, medical records and exemption from the food and drugs regulator; the United States chargé d'affaires said on 29 September it was meant to taper assistance toward country ownership.

The refused health agreement is back on the table: the President said the United States had asked to reopen the compact, to amend or remove the clauses Ghana objected to on pathogen profiles and medical records.

Kenya

The regulator's 2026 guidance notes on cross-border transfers add standard contractual clauses and a binding-corporate-rules application form to the April note. The document prints no issue date.

The Public Service Commission shortlisted 13 of 152 applicants to succeed the inaugural data commissioner at the end of her six-year term, among them the Media Council's chief executive and the senior deputy data commissioner; interviews are set for 5 October. The High Court ordered the largest operator on 18 September to give a subscriber, within 21 days, the particulars of every request to access or disclose her communications and mobile money data and the access logs it holds, under the constitutional right of access to information; compliance is not on record. The regulator told a parliamentary committee that deactivation and recycling of inactive numbers now run under its 2026 procedures and safeguards.

Lesotho

The ICT ministry's principal secretary told UNGA81 side meetings that the ministry had developed DPI Safeguards for Children with UNICEF Lesotho and is piloting them with the National University of Lesotho across five government ministries (23 September). Neither the text of the safeguards nor the ministries in the pilot are named.

Liberia

Officials posted enrolment lists of children in a social protection programme to Facebook, including home addresses, as proof the programme was real. On 13 September the gender and social protection ministry confirmed the records are authentic, said their disclosure was never authorised and opened an internal investigation.

Malawi

A gap the repository has carried since April closed this month, though not by the route that would have settled it. The United States embassy said Malawian biological specimens will be shared with Washington only during public health emergencies and outbreaks and that no personally identifiable information passes under the agreements, dating the specimen-sharing agreement to 11 February 2026 inside a five-year health package valued at US$936 million. Malawi must supply requested specimens within seven days and gets priority access to any resulting diagnostics, vaccines or therapeutics only after meeting its own domestic needs - a clause Malawian health advocates call a major limitation. The instrument's own text remains withheld and in litigation, so what is now on the record is the shape of the deal and both governments' account of it, not its terms.

Mali

The largest privacy fact of the month came from outside the country. A model provider's threat report says a consultant working with the state security agency used its AI model to build Lakana 360, a platform monitoring about 25 million SIM cards across all three mobile operators and capturing call records, messages and voice traffic, with a warrant requirement removed from one component. No Malian authority's response or legal basis for the interception is on record.

The authority's cooperation with Benin produced its first recorded joint action: Benin's First Rapporteur visited on 4 September for an exchange on compliance tools, regulatory standards, communication and Mali's regional offices at Kayes, Sikasso, Ségou and Mopti. No joint instrument or work plan from it is on record.

On 23 September the authority signed a cooperation agreement with Togo's personal-data authority providing for information exchange, cooperation on complaints handling and compliance checks, and staff training; the talks also covered cross-border data transfers, cybersecurity and artificial intelligence.

Mauritius

Interception gained its first reform instrument since the 2025 parliamentary revelations. The National Crime Agency Bill published by the National Assembly would make interception of communications, real-time collection and traffic-data preservation by the new agency subject to Judge in Chambers orders. The Assembly stands adjourned to 20 October, and no judicial-authorisation requirement is in force.

Morocco

The Casablanca prosecutor general opened a judicial investigation on 14 September into a party leader's claim that his party's phones were monitored, citing the conduct of the elections. No finding is held.

Mozambique

A media freedom organisation told a Maputo round table on 3 September that the draft Personal Data Protection Law must not restrict press freedom and the right to information; the ICT institute's board chair said approval of the law is only the start and needs supervision and accountability mechanisms. At a Maputo fair on 1-2 September the institute set out its registration and licensing regime for digital platforms and named enforcement capacity as the main challenge. Parliament's standing commission placed the personal data protection draft law on the agenda of the ordinary session opening on 28 October; no text is held.

Namibia

Refusing to share health data had a price. After the government rejected US terms on health data and specimens, the two governments announced that US HIV funding ends after a single US$45m year in fiscal 2027.

Nigeria

The commission opened a second framework alongside its enforcement work: validation of a data privacy framework for electronic commerce, at an Abuja workshop run with the German development agency and following a private-sector session in Lagos. No draft text, scope, commencement date or enforcement route is published, so what exists is a consultation rather than an instrument.

The consultation acquired a political timetable on 10 September, when the education minister trailed regulation of internet access for children under 16, to be announced by the security agencies within days or weeks. The announcement is to come from the security agencies rather than a regulator, and no draft instrument is named.

The commission moved into a new Abuja headquarters on 14 September, reporting 356 licensed compliance organisations, and its chief executive put compliance among advertising agencies at 12.3%. The data-protection commission and the orientation agency signed a memorandum on public data-protection awareness.

A law firm reported that the Federal High Court in Lagos held on 17 July 2026 that the data protection commission acted within its powers in designating point-of-sale operators as controllers and processors of major importance, so that they must register and pay the prescribed fees. The judgment itself is not held.

Senegal

The data protection commission published its quarterly opinion for April to June 2026: 195 files handled, 154 declarations and 41 authorisation requests, producing 153 declaration receipts and 39 authorisations, with one processing operation rejected, two data controllers heard, eight complaints received and one report. It is the first published measure of the commission's own throughput this ledger holds. It counts registrations rather than enforcement, and the commission still operates under a law unamended since 2008.

Seychelles

The information commission's visible work is inducting the officers other public bodies must appoint. It held the second of its two annual induction sessions for newly appointed information officers, led by its chief executive and a senior information analyst. The enforcement half of its mandate still shows no case: it has been the designated data-protection authority since December 2023, an enforcement-capacity gap was documented in November 2025, and no audit, investigation or fine against any controller has been reported. No count of officers inducted or bodies covered is published.

Sierra Leone

The communication, technology and innovation ministry, with UNICEF and a digital public infrastructure centre, led a three-day workshop on how government systems handle children's data, reported on 10 September.

South Africa

An extortion attack on an insurance-technology provider, detected on 14 June and reported to the regulator two days later, exposed personal information linked to customers of about 45 insurers. On 16 September one insurer said a ransomware group's claim against it came from that incident. The National Consumer Commission sought service providers for the national opt-out registry, aiming to have it live in 2026, with fines of up to R1m or 10% of turnover for non-compliant marketers. The state is buying the capability the framework does not yet govern. State IT agency tender documents require that police body-worn cameras must be able to conduct facial recognition and integrate with various security platforms, under a three-year contract RFB 3286-2026 whose bids close at 11am on 29 September 2026. No contract value, matching database, retention period or authorising legal instrument is published. The consumer commission launched the national opt-out registry, with direct marketers registering first and consumers able to register blocks from May 2027.

Tanzania

The community development ministry told parliament on 31 August 2026 that a National Advisory Committee on Online Child Protection and Safety has been established and that an online-safety education campaign had reached 1,811,212 children across all 26 mainland regions. The data protection commission reported 15,146 institutions registered with it and 445 personal-data complaints received by August 2026.

Togo

On 15 September the data protection authority convened ministry chiefs of staff and secretaries-general in Lome on their obligations under the 2019 law and the measures needed to bring public-sector processing into conformity. No count of administrations registered or compliant is published. On 30 September it opened its first certification session for data protection officers, assessing 32 professionals.

Tunisia

A digital-rights forum said on 3 October that the national data-protection authority's activity has stopped while its law remains in force, and called for it to be reactivated. The statement came with a condemnation of the spread of personal data, leaked judicial documents and images of child victims on social media. The authority has not answered on the record the repository holds. The communications ministry announced a regulator's decision of 10 June 2026 obliging internet providers to offer parental controls and write a child-protection clause into contracts.

Uganda

Three men were held at a Kampala station over alleged false news and unlawful obtaining or disclosure of personal data, reported on 1 September, on offences under the computer misuse statute; the posts, the data and the complainant are not disclosed. A TikTok user was charged with unlawfully obtaining and disclosing personal data over a photograph and video of a State House employee. The communications regulator launched a child online protection campaign at a Kampala secondary school.

Zambia

The technology ministry's permanent secretary said the country is implementing a national child online protection strategy for 2025 to 2029.

Zimbabwe

The child online protection policy moved to delivery. The ICT minister told the National Assembly on 9 September that content gateways are being installed on public free Wi-Fi and in schools, with teacher and parent training, under an implementation committee with two other ministries.

On 21 September the regulator held a consultative workshop on amendments to SI 155 that would set administrative fines; the amendment text is not on file.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	**2026-10-12**
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/topics/gov-protect/gov-protect-monthly-2026-10-12.pdf
FEEDBACK	info@data-landscapers.io
LICENCE	CC BY 4.0